

Community Questions and Topics

31 March 2026 ODSC Session: Lean Coffee Results

Topics are organised by theme. Vote counts reflect priority during the Lean Coffee session. Topics that received zero votes are listed separately. [Chat comments are shown in blue.](#)

Standards, API and Implementation

- **How integration and API standards and design might work to make sharing of this data implementable**

Votes: 18

- **Can example payloads be made available to support with testing the standards?**

Votes: 16

- **How will compliance with standards be verified?**

Votes: 14

- **If the submission specs are mandated but not implemented by software suppliers, what happens then?**

Votes: 13

- **Is compliance for application standards just when the app comes in, or throughout all changes?**

Votes: 5

Mandation Timeline and Policy

- **Do we have a specific target date for mandation from minister?**

Votes: 11

- **How far does mandating go? Just back office solutions or does it cover complementary suppliers such as Exacom, Commonplace etc?**

Votes: 14

Governance, Ownership and Direction

- **Clearer understanding of MHCLG long-term ownership and sense of direction of the planning standards concept as a whole**

Votes: 16

[One participant noted the need to align with things going on elsewhere in MHCLG such as housing data to avoid multiple government teams with incompatible asks.](#)

- **Understanding what the outcome or purpose of standardising any planning data is so we can design from that point**

Votes: 2

Data Coverage and Specification

- **How to capture end of permission data as this will have changed from the application form. Floorspace figures for instance**

Votes: 10

- **How to monitor housing permissions**

Votes: 10

- **Clear flow through connected applications, building on process diagrams. Is the Section 73 related to the outline or the reserved matters application? Which Section 73 is live and discharge of condition related to?**

Votes: 5

One participant suggested that proposals should be bundled with all related applications, not just vaguely attached discrete records. Compared it to a notebook-like record rather than a database record.

Spatial Data and Mapping

- **Unified GIS across the country for standardised layers. This will aid with validation as then the system would know constraints and validation requirements for different application types**

Votes: 15

- **Mapping base (GIS)**

Votes: 8

One participant noted this is a spatial question. If an application boundary covers a feature such as a flood area, postcodes and UPRN do not matter. Another commented that data links should be geolocated so applications can be identified on a map.

Cross-Sector Integration and Alignment

- **Alignment of English Planning Data standards with other regimes such as Building Control and other regions such as Wales**

Votes: 10

One participant noted the Building Control data standard work uses MHCLG planning data standard as the basis and welcomed contributions from the community to this work.

- **Linking council tax UPRN/ID to planning applications and building control applications**

Votes: 4

One participant suggested asking Geoplace about council tax collection links as they have good financial reasons to make this connection.

- **Mandatory provision of correct housing planning application on building control applications**

Votes: 3

Housing Development Data

- **Mandatory reporting of start and completion date per housing plots**

Votes: 7

- **Affordable housing tracking completions using Building Control vs addressing information**

Votes: 6

- **Will revised planning application forms include more information on housing developments including demolitions, change of use, dwelling conversions, student accommodation, bedspaces and tenure**

Votes: 1

- **Mandatory provision of housing plot schedules to accompany planning applications**

Votes: 2

Developer Contributions and Transparency

- **Making Developer Contributions More Transparent**

Votes: 6

One participant shared detailed feedback on using scraped planning data to identify housing developments, map boundaries and identify developer education contributions. They highlighted challenges in clearly defining dwelling numbers, tenure types, contribution triggers and development status. They offered to contribute to the specification to support making this data more transparent. Another participant noted similar data needs for statutory consultee purposes around identifying triggers and implementation of works via Section 106 and CIL obligations.

Data Access and Transparency

- **Making LPA-held data such as constraints publicly available nationwide**

Votes: 8

- **Are we providing enough information for applicants?**

Votes: 1

One participant emphasised that applicants must submit information they consider relevant to an application. This influences design and gives consultees something to review against. A constraint might exist in data, but what it means to the LPA and applicant can be two different things.

AI and Automation

- **Training specific LLMs from the data standards and published historic and current data to help improve planning validation and other features such as summary of technical documents for planning committees**

Votes: 9

- **Opportunities for automation particularly reporting**

Votes: 4

- **AI development space**

Votes: 5

Implementation and Capacity

- **What are the costs of holding and managing this data and will there be burdens and funding? If we move to cost recovery will this be covered by that?**

Votes: 11

- **Is there concern about LPAs not being aware of these conversations and the impact that this will have on them when we look at implementation and mandation?**

Votes: 7

Specific Application Types and Processes

- **Permitted Development Rights identification data standards and the how**

Votes: 7

- **LGR Implications (Local Government Reorganisation)**

Votes: 5

One participant noted the need to keep an eye on LGR and changes to authority boundaries.

- **How does digital planning link to the land use framework?**

Votes: 1

One participant asked whether the standards apply only to England or Wales too. It was confirmed that mandated standards apply to England only.

Community and Communication

- **We need to think about ways of working to engage with sector expertise**

Votes: 9

- **Mentioned in the chat, but dropping back in here: Case studies from the work and spotlighting the challenges and successes would be great. Help bring it to life and generate engagement and manage implementation expectations**

Votes: 8

One participant agreed that case studies would help bring the work to life and demonstrate tangible value. Another noted willingness to share interview findings on data and information management from LPA conversations to support the work.

- **Revisit monitoring needs and reporting requirements as part of community discussion. This is where data standards will have an impact or should**

Votes: 5

Topics with No Votes

The following topics were suggested but received no votes during the Lean Coffee session. They may still be important areas for future exploration.

- **What is a Section 257? (public rights of way diversions)**
- **Back to earlier question: planning resource in LPAs and training?**